



GAME JAM BRIEF

MUNDANE FANTASY

Welcome to the **Mundane Fantasy Game Jam**! Your task over the next few weeks is to flip the classic epic fantasy trope on its head. We don't want the Chosen One saving the world. We want the person who has to clean up after them.

The Theme: Mundane Fantasy

The game must focus on an **ordinary, everyday, or tedious task**, but set entirely within a **magical or high-fantasy world**.

Need inspiration?

- **The Magic Checkout:** Scan items and count out gold coins for rude adventurers at a potion or weapon shop.
- **Overlord HR:** Manage the complaints, holiday requests, and safety hazards of goblins working in an evil dungeon.
- **Arcane Janitor:** Clean up slime, fix broken potion bottles, and scrub dragon-scorch marks off the tavern floor.
- **Enchanted Allotment:** Use low-level spells to water cabbages, scare off magical pests, and pull mandrakes without deafening yourself.

The Constraints & Scope

CRITICAL RULE: Keep it small! This is a rapid prototyping exercise. Focus on **one core mechanic** and make it feel satisfying. We want a polished 2-minute loop, not a broken open world.

- **Team Size:** Solo or groups of up to 4 students.
- **Engine/Tools:** Any engine of your choice
- **Assets:** You **are allowed** to use asset packs, code templates, and online tutorials to help build your game. Don't reinvent the wheel...focus on design and implementation!

Key Dates & Deliverables

Phase 1: Ideation & Planning (Start Right Now!)

Before you touch any engine, you must complete:

1. **An Ideation/Mood Board:** (Figma or other) showing your visual style, references, and core ideas.
2. **Basic Planning Document:** A 1-page breakdown of your core mechanic, team roles (if in a group), and a simple Trello/Kanban board for task tracking.

Phase 2: The Submission

- **Deadline:** Friday 19th June 2026
- **What to submit:** A working, playable build of your game alongside your planning documentation.

Phase 3: Showcase

- **Presentations:** Week commencing Monday 22nd June 2026
- **The Pitch:** You will present your game to the class, demonstrating your gameplay loop and explaining how you managed your scope.

How You Will Be Judged

Criteria	What we are looking for
Theme Fit	How well does the game balance "boring daily chore" with "magical world"?
Scope Management	Is the game finished, stable, and playable? Did you avoid over-scoping?
Gameplay Polish	Does the core action (e.g., scanning an item, sweeping a floor) feel satisfying to do?
Production/Planning	Did you use your ideation board and planning docs effectively to manage your time?